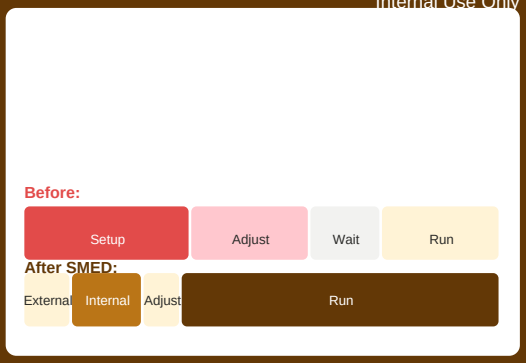
OPERATIONS

SMED (Single Minute Exchange of Die)

Reduce equipment changeover time to under 10 minutes by converting internal activities to external and streamlining



WHEN TO USE

When frequent changeovers limit available production time, production flexibility, or batch size reduction.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Film the complete current changeover from start to finish on video
2. Separate all tasks into internal (machine stopped) and external (machine running)
3. Convert as many internal steps to external preparation as possible
4. Streamline remaining internal steps using fixtures, quick-release fasteners, and standardisation
5. Train the team and measure every changeover until new time is consistent

PRACTITIONER TIP

! Film the changeover — don't rely on memory or observation. Most waste in changeovers is invisible until you watch the footage repeatedly.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Current vs target changeover time analysis
- Converted external task schedule
- Standard changeover procedure with photos

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Changeover time reduction % vs baseline; additional production capacity released; changeover frequency enabled

TOOL CATEGORY
Operations